H2 and the ownership promise: where the record stands (2026-10-13)

> **Status: DRAFT, written by the owner instance (Claude Opus 5.5, session tessera-e4).** It changes no registered sentence and adjudicates nothing. Revised once after a full Codex review (`docs/reviews/h2-record/`), whose nine findings were all accepted. The proposed README text in §5 is the author's to adopt or refuse; the README says the credibility line is his.

1. What is registered, and what the README promises

- **H2** (`docs/phase-0-prereg.md:225-231`): *"The architecture decisions are demonstrably mine; AI handled mechanics."* It is falsified only if the multi-model panel (the same ≥3 unrelated models as the security review, tasked to interrogate architecture ownership) *"finds a load-bearing decision I cannot justify without reconstructing it from the AI's reasoning."* Proposed A9 keeps this panel (A9:161-163).
- **The registered credibility line** (`docs/phase-0-prereg.md:86-89`): AI agents are *"not to* make *those decisions without consultation."*
- **The README's stronger promise** (`README.md:13-17`): AI *"never contributes … ownership: every load-bearing decision is read cold by the author, ratified or overridden, and defensible by the author without the AI in the room."*

The README promise and H2 are different tests. This note keeps them apart.

2. What happened

Ownership was delegated, in two steps. - 2026-09-17, the author: *"This is your project, you own it"* (corroborated in `docs/requests/2026-09-30-reply-to-governance-consent-calibration-study.md:5`). - 2026-10-12, returning the Q1 ruling: *"The decision to change that rule isn't mine, it is the owner of the project"* (A9:66-69).

Since then, proposed A9 labels most of the V1 profile OWNER DECISION. If A9 is signed, the author's signature on those items means that he has read them and does not object (A9:20-22). The exceptions are the five parameters A9.2 puts to him (δ, ε, k, N, S), which the signature ratifies as his.

Author contributions on the record, by kind:

Kind	Item	Source
Suggested	Throwaway prototype as a lens on the model	`prototype/README.md:3-13`; `formal/suite/capstone/READ-CAPSTONE-2026-10-06.md:78`
Required	Hardware protection for keys	A9:91-92
Required	Limited key lifetimes, as a product concern	A9:93-95. The 90-day window rule implementing it is OWNER.
Preferred	PQ signing	A9:96-97. The conditional hybrid, its fallback and its pass criteria are OWNER.
Corrected	Contracts may ride in `content`	A9:85-90. Cases i and i′ are an OWNER addition.
Ruled	`wamason.com` as D	A9:63-64
Adopted	Decisions A, B, C (B: revocation not evaluated, optional add-on)	A9:51-59. Owner/Codex drafted the options.

Kind	Item	Source
Proposed, 2026-10-13 live session	Signers in two clouds without internet exposure, the API layer in a third, latency accepted because T is chain-bound, front-end compromise named as residual. The owner adopted the signer isolation for V1 and recorded the API split as a V2 note. The author's principle: heterogeneous layers, defeated when procurement makes them identical	Live session; runbook §1
Stated, 2026-10-13 live session	Purpose: "most things are not attested"; make attestation cheap and easy; surviving the service's exit is distinctive	Live session; not yet in the repo

Earlier, recorded adoptions after consideration are also counterevidence to any claim that the author only watched: - `formal/spike/DECISION.md:13-22`: a tool recommendation ratified after cold model reads; - `formal/spike/first-link/DECISION.md:366-371`: a required-set recommendation, adopted; - `formal/spike/standing-probe/DECISION.md:378-398`: standing selection, adopted after two independent probes.

The first-link decision (`:100-119`) also records the author's own distinction between defending core design decisions and reproducing individual proofs.

AI-made, after the delegation. OWNER decisions in A9 include: - the code rule replacing "Before any code"; - the signature-inclusive anchor and the sign–freeze–stamp order; - the issuance window and slot rules; - the hybrid signer profile; - the root-KSK rule; - most review dispositions.

The P8 encoding, the formal suite and the prototype were built by AI.

The author's reading, 2026-10-13 (live session): > *"I've been actively involved, but realistically I have not made every critical decision. I'd argue that's the > right balance."* > > *"I suppose, at some level, it* is *'vibe coded'. I explained (often multiple times) my goals for the project and > AI have run with that, lost themselves in the details, forgotten the higher objectives, re-learned of them from > where I asked questions or made suggestions that the direction was drifting, but in the end AI has been > implementing things."* > > *"if something is presented to me and I agree with it, that is 'did not object' but it doesn't mean I did not > consider the option, either."*

He also said the plan was a 4–6 week cycle; the project, initiated 10 June (`README.md:22`), is in its fifth month. H2 has no elapsed-time condition, so this is a schedule divergence, not H2 evidence.

3. Where each test stands — OWNER reading, contestable

- **The README promise: does not hold.** Load-bearing decisions have been made by the AI owner, and under proposed A9 the author's signature on them records no objection, not ratification. This follows from the delegation alone.
- **H2: pending, not adjudicated.** Delegation and AI origin do not show that the author *cannot justify* a load-bearing decision; only the registered panel can find that. No panel has been run. The owner's expectation is that some post-delegation decisions would be hard for the author to defend unaided. That is a prediction, recorded here so it can be checked, not a finding.
- **4 December: product evidence only.** The relying-party test and the 2106-examiner test (`docs/V1-SCHEDULE.md:13-16`; A9:107-118) test whether V1's documentation and tools let one independent tester reach safe decisions on the registered mapping. They say nothing about

who made the decisions or whether stewardship was enough. A pass cannot rehabilitate H2, and a fail does not falsify it.

- **The prototype.** `prototype/TRIAGE.md:74` reports 0 WRONG, 21 MISSING and 50 DEFER, with its stated limits:
  - exact model abstractions in stubbed areas;
  - the same model family as the spec (`:31-37`);
  - authority-channel scope assessed by analysis, not tested (`:96-97`).

  The author requested it, and AI built and analysed it. It is an implementation-facing check, not an independent one.

Continuation rests on the accepted V1 schedule and the author's ship-or-stop decision on 4 December (`docs/V1-SCHEDULE.md:3,28`), not on any H2 outcome. For a different hypothesis, the prereg has an honest-stop clause: *"If H0 cannot be met, the project does not proceed as designed — and that is a valid, honest outcome of this pre-registration, not a failure to conceal"* (`:734-735`). It is cited here only as the project's stance on reporting divergence; it is not an H2 rule.

4. Proposals, not rules

- **Run the H2 panel.** It is the registered adjudicator. It examines the author, so when to run it is his call. The owner's suggestion is after the 30 Oct freeze, when the V1 decision set is fixed.
- **Recording consideration.** When the author agrees with an owner recommendation after considering it, a sentence of his reason can be recorded alongside the OWNER label, keeping the original provenance. That documents consideration. It does not show comprehension and does not discharge H2.
- **Routing.**
  - The author receives in full, with links to the complete findings: findings that change direction, findings about authorship or credibility, and evidence against the owner's own conclusions.
  - Routine prover output and vectors are summarised, with links.
  - Judgments that A9 still reserves to the author (A9:216) stay his.

5. Proposed README credibility line (for the author to adopt, edit or refuse)

> Since September 2026, by explicit delegation, an AI owner instance has made many of the detailed design decisions; each is labelled OWNER in the record. The author sets direction, states requirements, corrects drift and rules on what is put to him. The original promise that AI never contributes ownership no longer holds; see `docs/h2-record-2026-10-13.md`. Whether the architecture decisions remain demonstrably the author's (H2) is decided by the registered panel, not by this README.